by us."[2] The IDF indeed played into the hands of the Egyptians, and in the counterattack on October 8 it suffered many losses, lost many tanks in an assault on infantry forces (which were equipped with Sagger missiles), and did not improve the IDF's position on the front.

On October 12, the seventh day of the war, with the IDF already weary, a discussion was held with the extended cabinet, headed by Golda Meir. Lieutenant General (res.) Haim Bar-Lev, who had been appointed as commander of the southern front a few days earlier, reported to the cabinet on the situation on the front and strongly recommended not to wait for the Egyptian counterattack but to launch an attack beyond the Canal the next day, on the thirteenth of the month, despite the many risks involved. The commander of the air force, Major General Benny Peled, supported Bar-Lev; IDF deputy chief of staff Yisrael Tal objected to his suggested course of action; Chief of Staff Dado was hesitant; and Defense Minister Dayan was also not convinced. The dilemma was serious. Then Zamir was called out of the meeting to receive some urgent information that had just come in. When he returned to the meeting he relayed that a reliable source had been told that the Egyptians were about to begin the second phase of their attack on the passes in the next day or two. Golda's reaction was, "Well, I understand that Zvika Zamir has ended our discussion."[3] It was decided to postpone the IDF counterattack and wait for the Egyptian army east of the Canal, where it would be "crushed" in its attempt to break through the crossings; from there the IDF would move from a position of superiority to a counterattack to the west of the Canal. The Egyptian army did indeed launch the second stage of its attack on October 14 and suffered a severe blow on the east of the Canal—between 150 and 250 Egyptian tanks were destroyed. On October 15 the IDF began crossing the Canal, and by the eighteenth it had established a clear position of superiority as it reached the Canal's west bank.

The head of the Mossad also made a major contribution to formulating Israel's strategy vis-à-vis the Egyptians and the United States. As mentioned, Zamir met with Marwan twice more, on October 19 and 29, and the intelligence he brought, especially the insight that the Egyptians and Syrians were not interested in a cease-fire and wanted to drag Israel into a war of attrition west of the Suez Canal, influenced Golda's decision to travel to the United States for meetings with Kissinger and Nixon. The Kissinger-Alexei Kosygin agreement on a cease-fire, which was achieved in